

Milestone 3: Initial Prototype, User Test Plans

Now that you have developed an initial design concept based on your understanding of your users and the competitive landscape, it's time to develop the concept to the point that you can test it with users. In this milestone, you will detail your design by creating wireframes, and then build a low-fi prototype to prepare for user testing. As the last step in this milestone, you will create a plan for the user test you will conduct in Milestone 4.

Step	Activities	Output
Create wireframes	Identify key tasks Create wireframes Create key navigation flows	Key wireframes Key navigation flows
Create prototype	Identify scope (at least 3 key tasks) Choose scenarios, create dummy data Create low-fi prototype screens	Low-fi prototype
Design user test	Define recruiting criteria and strategy Define tasks Write task instructions Create test materials: questionnaires, informed consent, logging forms, scripts Determine and test recording technology	Test design Test materials

Activity Descriptions

Important: The activities should be completed in order, though you may wish to go back and update your wireframes as you develop your low-fi prototype. Certain things become clear when trying to build a prototype that users can interact with that are harder to see when creating static wireframes.

Activity 1: Create Wireframes

Step	Activities	Output
Create wireframes	Identify key tasks Create wireframes Create key navigation flows	Key wireframes Key navigation flows

Create at least 10 wireframes using a prototyping tool. The wireframes should be low-fidelity, meaning they use just one basic font, no colors other than black and white, and maintain a rough, unfinished look. Sticking with low-fidelity wireframes will help ensure that your effort is well-placed and encourage high-level feedback from users who participate in your upcoming user test.

Your wireframes should cover two categories: **key screens** and **key navigation flows**. Key screens are ones that are frequently visited by users, and include things like “home screens” as well as commonly-accessed “detail pages” (e.g., Amazon’s product page, or Gmail’s single message view). Additionally, you should identify 5 **key navigation flows** that users will traverse to accomplish important tasks they will need to perform with your design (Important: look ahead to the low-fi prototype and user test to make sure the flows you’re choosing are the ones you’ll need later). Each stage of these flows should be represented by a wireframe, and the connections between sequential wireframes should be made clear in your report.

Activity 2: Create paper prototype

Step	Activities	Output
Create a prototype	Identify scope (at least 6 key tasks) Choose key tasks Create low-fi prototype screens Create dummy data	Low-fi prototype

In preparation for your first user test, you will produce a prototype using Figma or Lovable. The screens and supporting elements will need to be rendered for your user test. The prototype needs to cover all user interactions for the 6 tasks you will include in your user test. It is a good idea to include screens for any “wrong” interactions or paths that you think are reasonably likely for the user to pursue.

Make sure that dynamic elements in your interface, such as drop-down lists, search results, shopping carts, etc. have realistic data that is relevant to the selected tasks, which can either be included directly in the wireframes or in the prototype.

Activity 3: Design user test

Step	Activities	Output
Design user test	Define recruiting criteria and strategy Define tasks Write task instructions Create test materials: questionnaires, informed consent, logging forms, scripts Determine and test recording technology	Test plan Supporting materials

The final activity in Milestone 3 is to create the plan that you will use for your user test. You can base your test plan and materials off of the **Hipmunk test plan**. You will need to design your own tasks from scratch, and adapt other components of the test plan to your project as necessary. It will be important to think about how you will record your user test sessions so that you can review them thoroughly.

Milestone Deliverables

Produce a single document (.pdf) with three clearly marked sections: Wireframes, Prototype and User Test Plan.

Section 1: Wireframes

- Images (photos, exported images, or screenshots) of all of the wireframes you produced, with a brief description of each. Be sure that the images are large enough and of high enough resolution that all text and details can be clearly seen.
- Separately, show the navigation flow among wireframes for key tasks that users will need to perform using the system. For this, you will probably re-use the wireframe images, but shrink them down so that multiple fit on a page and use arrows to show how one screen transitions to another.

Section 2: Prototype

Include a link to your prototype. Ensure the link is publicly accessible and does not require the reviewer to request access.

Section 3: User Test Plan

The User Test Plan will, itself, have several subsections. In particular:

User Test Plan Overview: A description of the test, including high level goals, recruiting criteria, components of

the test, and sequence of activities for the test sessions. This document should also include the specific task instructions that you will give to users.

Consent Form: The form describing the test, data being recorded, and how you will handle test data/outcomes in terms of confidentiality. This is a form you will ask participants to read and sign.

Logging Sheet: A form you will use for noting critical incidents, task success and failure, and other notable events during the test sessions (or during subsequent review of the video recordings).

User Test Script: an outline of the steps you will need to take to prepare for and complete each test session, along with wording you will use for your interactions with test participants.

Post-Test Questionnaire: the questionnaire you will administer to participants after they complete the tasks. You should use the SUS unless you have a good reason not to (and the reason should be explained in the test plan).

Submission Instructions

Please submit a pdf file with the name format : HCI-Spring2026-M3-**YourTeamName**.pdf Note: Only the placeholders in red will be replaced with your respective ones. The pdf must be submitted on google classroom. The corresponding presentation should be **15 minutes long**.

